WHOI S2A/ALTO Argo Float Deployment Instructions – Hand Deployment

We would like to thank you for assisting Woods Hole Oceanographic Institution and the International Argo program in deploying Argo Floats for us. We appreciate your time and contributions to the global observing network.

These instructions assume that the floats have been previously initialized and passed self-tests. Do NOT deploy until proper startup has been confirmed with WHOI technicians.

1. Remove the outer plastic sleeve and shrink wrap. The box is sealed with water-soluble tape and is totally biodegradable. Any stickers on the box are paper based and also biodegradable. Avoid getting the tape or the box wet so that it will remain intact during deployment.

2. If there is cardboard at the bottom, remove and save it to rest the float on before deployment.

3. Secure the float while waiting for deployment. Rest the float on the cardboard keep the bottom of the float and water-soluble tape dry.



Note: Your floats will not have yellow straps on them.

4. Arrive at the station and get the 'go ahead' from the bridge. The ship's speed should be between 1-2 knots and the float deployed on the lee side.

5. The deployment box has hand-hold flaps cut into the top of the box (not the heavy end). Lower the float into the water. Ensure that the deployment box is in the water before letting go. If the freeboard is too high to allow the deployer to hold onto the box until it touches the water please use the sling method for deployment (see 'SlingDirection.pdf' document.) Do not allow the float/box to freefall into the water.



6. Mark the time and position (latitude/longitude) of the deployment. Fill in the launch date, position, time, etc. on the Deployment Log sheet. If it is possible, email the launch information with the float serial number, launch date and position to deploymentinfo@whoi.edu.